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Brief Study of Cybercrime on an Internet

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Abstract

Cybercrime is a serious challenge to society and is harmful to the individuals who become victims. This research paper engages analysis of the cybercrimes that target individuals on the internet and also examines the motivation of criminals that perform such attacks which include (e. g phishing, scams), online harassment, identity theft, malware, hacking and denial-of-service crimes. Cybercrime is a threat to today's internet-dependent society and is a huge growing problem. By research, it is found that people are using online banking, online shopping and online social networking. Digital technology provides benefits and it provides a rich environment for criminal activity to steal an identity to the theft of classified government information, also known as hacking. A few short examples include buying and selling illegal software and malware, hacking of servers, corrupting systems that could cost billions to individuals, organizations, and government. Cybercrime refers to any crime performed using a computer or an electronic device, mainly through the Internet. As the Internet has many opportunities to consume and access information. Cyber-attacks have mainly caused damage to banking using a credit card and payment scams. Remember, while working within a business, each person has to take personal responsibility for ensuring cybersecurity. You have to prioritize risks that are likely to affect and team up to create the strongest defence against cyberattacks. The study identified security measures are required as well as knowledge of the potential dangers of the Internet. Various steps are taken to slow down attacks but unfortunately are not able to achieve success. The reasons for cyber-attacks, 1. Countries having weak cyber securities, 2. Criminals use new technologies to attack, 3. Cybercrime with business schemes. Every human being is connected by using the internet and it makes the world small. Awareness should be spread regarding cyber-crimes and strict punishments should be imposed on cyber criminals so that criminals leave the idea to do any crime. It ought to guarantee that laws shaped should be followed appropriately.

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Brief Study of Cybercrime on an Internet

Raj Singh Deora¹, Dhaval Chudasama^{2*}

Abstract

Cybercrime is a serious challenge to society and is harmful to the individuals who become victims. This research paper engages analysis of the cybercrimes that target individuals on the internet and also examines the motivation of criminals that perform such attacks which include (e. g phishing, scams), online harassment, identity theft, malware, hacking and denial-of-service crimes. Cybercrime is a threat to today's internet-dependent society and is a huge growing problem. By research, it is found that people are using online banking, online shopping and online social networking. Digital technology provides benefits and it provides a rich environment for criminal activity to steal an identity to the theft of classified government information, also known as hacking. A few short examples include buying and selling illegal software and malware, hacking of servers, corrupting systems that could cost billions to individuals, organizations, and government. Cybercrime refers to any crime performed using a computer or an electronic device, mainly through the Internet. As the Internet has many opportunities to consume and access information. Cyber-attacks have mainly caused damage to banking using a credit card and payment scams. Remember, while working within a business, each person has to take personal responsibility for ensuring cybersecurity. You have to prioritize risks that are likely to affect and team up to create the strongest defence against cyberattacks. The study identified security measures are required as well as knowledge of the potential dangers of the Internet. Various steps are taken to slow down attacks but unfortunately are not able to achieve success. The reasons for cyber-attacks, 1. Countries having weak cyber securities, 2. Criminals use new technologies to attack, 3. Cybercrime with business schemes. Every human being is connected by using the internet and it makes the world small. Awareness should be spread regarding cyber-crimes and strict punishments should be imposed on cyber criminals so that criminals leave the idea to do any crime. It ought to guarantee that laws shaped should be followed appropriately.

Keywords: Cybercrime, cyberattacks, cyber security, cyber criminals, Business schemes.

INTRODUCTION

Rapid technological growth and developments have provided new opportunity and productive sources for organizations of all sizes. Technological growth is majorly braced by the internet and new technologies have brought threats and cybercrime continues to evolve with new threats. It's an

effective idea to know how to recognize cybercrime to help protect yourself from attack and how to protect your data. Hackers are turning to Internet-based social networking sites for exploitation. Today anyone can send and receive any form of data, be it an e-mail, audio or video by just clicking the button. The Internet is the fastest-growing infrastructure in everyday life and the latest technologies are changing the face of mankind. But due to these emerging technologies, we are unable to safeguard our private information

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and hence these days' cybercrimes are increasing day by day. Today more than 60 per cent of commercial transactions are done online and this needs high security. The scope of cybersecurity is not limited to securing the information in the IT industry but also to various other fields like cyberspace. Even the latest technologies like cloud computing, mobile computing, E-commerce, net banking etc also need a high level of security as it holds some important information regarding a person whose security has become a must thing. Improving cybersecurity and protecting information is important to each nation's safety and economic wellbeing. Making the Internet safer has become crucial to the development of new services as well as governmental policy. The battle against cybercrime needs an extensive and safer approach. Given that technical measures alone cannot prevent any crime, law enforcement agencies must be allowed to investigate and charge cybercrime effectively. Today many nations and governments are imposing strict laws to prevent the loss. Every individual must also be trained in cybersecurity. Technology has influenced everything from governments and market economies to global trade, travel, and communications. There are many benefits of the online world and cons too. In a study, 30 economies including the United Kingdom, United States of America (US), and Australia, it was the citizens that spent the most time online—at eight hours fifty-nine minutes, per day—across PC and mobile devices. Brazil at second with eight hours, trailed by Thailand at eight hours 49 minutes. A major reason for this increased Internet usage is social media, and particularly individuals use platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, YouTube, Twitter and instant messaging services. Internet crime is the most active and strong sector of cybercrime. Identity theft, Internet scams and cyberstalking are the major types of Internet crime [1-3].

Common forms of cybercrime include:

- *Phishing*: fake email messages to get personal information;
- Identity theft
- hacking websites or computer networks;
- Spreading hate and inflammatory terrorism;
- Child pornography
- grooming
- Violating copyright
- Selling illegal items
- Soliciting, producing child pornography

Computer crime embraces crimes such as phishing, credit card frauds, illegal downloading, industrial espionage, child pornography, scams, cyberterrorism, and so on. Some crimes committed on the Internet have been disclosed to the world and some remain a mystery. People have been trying to solve virus problems by installing virus protection software to protect their computers. The reality is that Internet culprits are barely caught. Internet users need to use unique passwords, run anti-virus and anti-spyware software. The internet is the reason for pornography which falls under the category of obscenity and is punishable. Internet crimes against children are a matter of concern and this problem has no easy solution. While the internet is an amazing device and has become an indiscernible part of our lives, there's a lot out there that could cause serious problems [4-6]

Objective

The theme of the paper targets to spread the knowledge of the crimes and offences that take place through the internet and brief information on cybercrime and the impact of social media in online crime by internet users in the emerging world. This paper also focuses on how to prevent cybercrimes on the internet and the types and effects of cybercrimes on the Internet [7].

What is Cybercrime?

Cybercrime is a term used to describe criminal activity in which computers or computer networks

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are uses as a tool and is used to perform the criminal activity. Digital Crime through the web has developed significant as the PC has gotten integral to diversion reason, trade and government. PC wrongdoing fundamentally comprises of unapproved admittance to PC frameworks information change, information obliteration, and burglary of protected innovation. Cybercrime includes many different types of profit-driven criminal activity, including email and internet fraud, identity theft, attempts to steal financial accounts, and steal data from corporate corporations. Cybercriminals use various pathways to carry out cyberattacks and are seeking new techniques and skills without fear of detention and arrest. Infecting systems and networks with malware is used to damage the software or data stored on the system. Cybercriminals also attempt to attack website to change or delete content or to access or modify databases without authorization. Other common examples of cybercrime include illegal gambling, selling of illegal items like weapons, drugs and production, possession or distribution of child pornography. It can include the theft of government information or corporate secrets through illegal activity by remote systems around the globe. Cybercrime also entails anything from downloading illegal records to stealing wealth from online bank accounts [8-10].

Types of Cybercrime Examined:

Cyberstalking

Cyberstalking is a crime that involves electronic means to stalk, harass and abuse one person targeted specifically for reasons of anger, revenge or rage [11].

Hacking

Hacking is a crime that involves cracking systems and gaining unauthorized access to the data. A lot of hackers try to gain access to resources through the use of password cracking software for accessing a computer. As computer networking and the Internet has exploded in popularity and so it becomes the most common target for hackers [11].

Phishing

Phishing is an act of fooling people to acquire financial details, personal information such as username, password to access their account. Phishers use several different social engineering and email spoofing toys to trick victims [11].

Software Piracy

It is an illegal act to reproduce and distribute software for business or personal use. Trademark violation, copyright infringement and patent violation are associated with this type of cybercrime [12].

Espionage

It means theft of trade secrets through systems or networks to gain access to confidential information held by the government or other organization. Espionage activities can include every type of cyberattack to gather, modify or destroy data to spy on targeted individuals or groups and monitoring communications, including emails, text messages and instant messages [12].

Password Sniffers

A programme is made to monitor and record the name and password of network users as they log in. Whoever installs the sniffer can log in to access restricted documents [12].

Credit/Debit Card Fraud

It involves stealing information from the card and is used to make hefty purchases.

Email Bombing

This is a serious crime in which a person sends several emails to the target system/person.

Vishing

Vishing is an electronic misrepresentation strategy wherein people are fooled into uncovering basic monetary or individual data to unapproved elements. A vishing attack can be conducted by voice

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email, landline or telephone [13].

Types of Cybercrime on the Internet:

- Cyberbullying and harassment
- Financial extortion
- Internet threats
- Global security data theft
- Password trafficking
- Personal data hacking
- Copyright violations
- Illegal weapon trafficking
- Child pornography
- Credit card theft and fraud
- Email phishing
- Cyber Espionage
- Virus spreading

Scams through Internet:

Online Investment Scam

Many people save money for future savings. Online investment scams target individuals and promise a good return but later no money in return is seen [2].

Online Dating Scam

Online dating is done on a large platform. People create fake profiles and then use them for their benefit. They demand and use their information later [3].

Fake Lottery Scam

A fake lottery scam is done through a website, texting or email. The scammer then asks for personal information or bank details to steal their savings [4].

Product or Drug Scam

Many people search online to buy medicines or products online as they are sold at discounted rates. Later these medicines are never delivered once purchased or either they haven't approved medicines and can pose serious health issues. The product scam comes in many forms by selling products at low cost or sometimes even for free. Do good research on the product to find what ingredients it contains and what reviews it has [5].

Commercial Scam

This type of scam targets both in-person and online. This could be in the form in which a website offers packages at a cheaper price and ends up selling by adding additional service fees [6].

Types of cybercrime that have Impacted the economy:

- -The loss of IP address and business-confidential information.
- -Online extortion and economic crimes.
- -Financial manipulation of a company publicly.
- -Many activities over the internet reduced trust.
- -Reputational damage to the company and its brand.

Prevention

Cybercrime risks can be reduced by following these steps:

- develop strong policies and procedures for business and employees;

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- create a security system to protect data and system;
- use two-factor authentication application;
- verify the request to send money before the transaction;
- create detection system that flags fake emails;
- train employees on cybersecurity policies and procedures;
- keep websites, devices and systems up to date with the latest software;
- backup data and information regularly to reduce the damage in case of an attack;
- Be aware of emails with links or attachments you didn't expect;
- Don't download anything from unknown sources;
- Don't use public Wi-Fi
- Use strong and unique passwords
- Make sure to keep your social networking profiles private
- Don't trust everything sold online.
- Enable your privacy settings when using social networking sites.
- In the era of online technology, parents should monitor all the activities of their children online using parental control.
- Try not to panic if you are a victim such as a child exploitation, identity theft, or a commercial scam, report this to your local police [10-13].

CONCLUSION

Today hackers are distributed across the world in large numbers. Many government and private agencies like the FBI, CIA, and state police are working to detect these hackers, but we must protect ourselves and our private data from online frauds. Apart from this, uneducated people should be given information about debit cards, credit cards, the internet, and computer. It is a bit difficult to catch hackers because they sit in one country and hack the computer from another country, so the best way to avoid these things is to be careful and alert. The Internet also relates to national security as computers serve roles in delivering emergency services, government operations, banking, transportation, energy, and telecommunications. Even though data provides users with innumerable opportunities, these benefits can be exploited for criminal purposes. To protect against cybercrime, security measures are needed that are designed to protect data and user's privacy. These problems should be solved, the problems are being addressed, although probably not fast enough to process them. The usefulness of the Internet has proved itself in numerous ways that ensure it does not become a wasteland of criminal activity. The prevention needs to be done by commercial commodities producing software and those with the potential to stop crime. As technology develops, the law needs to respond to those who would misuse the new technology. For prevention workshops, free advertisements, public interest with the help of the government & NGO'S. The process of acknowledgement about cyber world crimes and cyber illiteracy should be started from the grassroots level; institutes, computer centres, schools & individuals. Technology-based crimes have been developing with the passage of every day and they need to be solved with absolute priority. Any sort of crime should never be tolerated. The wellbeing and prosperity of residents ought to be defended. Everyone deserves a right to live in a secure environment, no matter in real life or on the Internet. After researching this issue, cyber-crime is more serious than real-life crime, as it affects millions of web users at once.

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loans to SMEs (Nanto 2009; Song and Zhou 2020; Alber 2020). Goel (2020), Deora and Chudasama (2021) is of the opinion that countries are exploiting the social and economic advantages of the Internet and are afraid of threats to national security. In response to these threats, countries are gradually strengthening their Internet borders and developing cyber weapons to prevent and mitigate conflicts. ...

... In response to these threats, countries are gradually strengthening their Internet borders and developing cyber weapons to prevent and mitigate conflicts. A potential downside of such federal regulation is inhibiting the rapid innovation that the Internet has traditionally fostered and restricting freedom of expression that has led to social inclusion in society (Goel 2020; Deora and Chudasama 2021). ...

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... Additionally, privacy is crucial to protecting individuals from harm. Within today's digital age, personal information is increasingly being used to target individuals for various forms of exploitation, such as identity theft, fraud, and harassment [9]. A study conducted by the Norton LifeLock indicated that in the year 2020, around 20% of adults in the United States were victims of identity theft, with financial losses totaling \$17 billion [10]. ...

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... However, in as much as the COVID-19 pandemic has necessitated the use of the Internet, ICT, and computer networks to work remotely, it has also introduced a new wave of criminal activity called cybercrime [5]. Cybercrime can be described as any illegal activity in which computers or computer networks are used as a tool to perform criminal activities [6]. Authors in [7] define it as those crimes committed through a computer or an electronic device, mainly through the Internet. ...

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... As technology advances, cybercrime evolves when malicious actors capitalize on the digital sphere by pursuing nefarious activities. Below is a list of cybercrimes (Batra et al., 2020; Deora & Chudasama, 2021) 1. Phishing 2. Identity theft 3. Hacking systems and websites 4. Child pornography 5. Cyber grooming 6. Copyright violations 7. Selling illegal items 8. Soliciting/producing child pornography 9. Financial theft 10. ...

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cybercriminal threats calls for a multifaceted and agile approach beyond detection and disruption, incorporating deterrence and prevention [46]. In response to the prospect of infiltration by malicious actors, small business owners need to implement proactive methods for loss prevention, including a formal incident response plan; a compliance plan comprised of policies, audits, training, and education; detection systems; and procedures for maintaining evidence of an incident. ...

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